COURSE SLIDES · WSQ

Conflict Management

WSQ Course Code: TGS-2026066849

Conducted by Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd

UEN 201200696W

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COURSE ADMINISTRATION

Welcome & Housekeeping

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Digital Attendance (Mandatory)

1

Three times a day

Take the AM, PM and Assessment digital attendance — mandatory for SkillsFuture-funded courses.

2

Trainer shows the QR

The trainer or administrator displays the digital attendance QR code from the SSG portal.

3

Scan and submit

Scan the QR code with your mobile phone camera and submit your attendance.

4

75% minimum

A minimum of 75% attendance is required to be eligible for assessment and funding.

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About the Trainer



Your Trainer

General Trainer template —
to be completed by the trainer

NAME

TITLE / DESIGNATION

QUALIFICATIONS

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

TRAINING & INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

CONTACT

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YOUR TRAINER

About the Trainer



Dr. Alfred Ang

Principal Trainer
Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd

ROLE
Principal Trainer, Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd

CREDENTIALS
20+ years of training and industry experience; adult educator for WSQ programmes.

DELIVERS
WSQ programmes in leadership, workplace communication, digital transformation and professional capability.

FOUNDER
Founder and lead instructor at Tertiary Infotech / Tertiary Courses.

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ICE-BREAKER

Let's Know Each Other

1

Who you are

Your name, organisation and role.

2

Your context

One kind of workplace disagreement you see — in general terms, without naming real people.

3

Your goal

One conflict-handling skill you want to strengthen today.

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HOUSEKEEPING

Ground Rules

1. **Phones on silent**
   Step out for urgent calls.
2. **Participate actively**
   No question is too small.
3. **Respect confidentiality**
   What is shared in role plays stays in the room.
4. **One conversation at a time**
   Listen to understand.
5. **Psychological safety**
   Anyone may pause or switch a role at any time.
6. **Be punctual**
   75% attendance is required.

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COURSE ACCREDITATION

Skill & Course Structure

1

Skill

Conflict Management

2

Course reference

TGS-2026066849 · 1 day · 8 hours

3

Structure

Five topics, five learning outcomes, eight workplace activities.

4

Assessment

Written Assessment (30 min) and Live Role Play (30 min).

5

Methods

Interactive presentation, role-play and facilitated discussion.

6

Ratio of practice

Over half of the training time is role play and case work.

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FIVE TOPICS · EIGHT ACTIVITIES

Course Outline

1

Topic 1 — Understanding Workplace Conflict and Management Styles

Conflict types · Escalation cycle · Warning signs · Thomas-Kilmann modes · Situational selection

2

Topic 2 — Communication Techniques for Diffusing Tensions

Active listening · Empathy · Reframing · Neutral language · Non-verbal cues · Self-regulation

3

Topic 3 — Negotiation and Consensus-Building Strategies

Positions · Interests · BATNA · Reservation points · ZOPA · Option generation · Resistance · Consensus

4

Topic 4 — Achieving Resolution and Protecting Organisational Interests

Structured resolution process · Mediation stages · Impartiality · Option evaluation · Action planning

5

Topic 5 — Sustaining a Conflict-Resilient Organisation

Guidelines · Escalation protocols · Psychological safety · Root-cause review · Monitoring and review

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SCHEDULE · 420 MIN TRAINING + 60 MIN ASSESSMENT

Lesson Plan — 1 Day, 9:00am to 6:00pm

9:00am – 9:15am	Welcome, introductions, ground rules, learning outcomes and mandatory AM digital attendance	15 min
9:15am – 10:30am	**Topic 1 — Understanding Workplace Conflict and Management Styles**	75 min
10:30am – 10:40am	Tea break	10 min
10:40am – 11:55am	**Topic 2 — Communication Techniques for Diffusing Tensions**	75 min
11:55am – 12:30pm	**Topic 3 (part 1) — Negotiation and Consensus-Building**	35 min
12:30pm – 1:30pm	Lunch break	60 min
1:30pm – 2:10pm	**Topic 3 (part 2) — Activity 4 — Interest-Based Negotiation at CarePoint Clinics**	40 min
2:10pm – 3:25pm	**Topic 4 — Achieving Resolution and Protecting Organisational Interests**	75 min
3:25pm – 3:35pm	Tea break	10 min
3:35pm – 4:50pm	**Topic 5 — Sustaining a Conflict-Resilient Organisation**	75 min
4:50pm – 5:00pm	Course wrap-up, briefing for assessment, TRAQOM and assessment digital attendance	10 min
5:00pm – 5:30pm	**Written Assessment (WA) — open-ended short-answer questions on LO1 and LO5, 30 minutes, open book**	30 min
5:30pm – 6:00pm	**Live Role Play (RP) — individual observed role play on LO2, LO3 and LO4, 30 minutes**	30 min

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WHAT YOU'LL ACHIEVE

Learning Outcomes

1

LO1 · Analyse and select

Analyse conflict types, escalation stages and the five management styles to choose a fitting approach.

2

LO2 · De-escalate

Use active listening, empathy, reframing and non-verbal skills to calm and steer conflict conversations.

3

LO3 · Negotiate and build consensus

Negotiate on interests, manage resistance and power, and test consensus on a shared agreement.

4

LO4 · Resolve and mediate

Run a structured resolution or mediation and turn it into an actionable, policy-aligned plan.

5

LO5 · Prevent recurrence

Set guidelines, escalation protocols and leadership habits that keep conflict constructive.

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BEFORE YOU START

Briefing for Assessment

1

Do · Clear your desk

Place phones and other materials under the table or on the floor.

2

Don't · No recording

No photos or recording of assessment scripts or role plays.

3

Don't · No discussion

Work individually — no discussion during the assessment.

4

Do · Black or blue pen

Use a black or blue pen for hard-copy assessments.

5

Don't · No correction fluid

No liquid paper or correction tape may be used.

6

Do · Stop on time

Scripts are collected and role plays end when time is up.

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FINAL ASSESSMENT · 5:00PM – 6:00PM

Assessment

1

Written Assessment (WA)

Open-ended short-answer questions on LO1 and LO5 · 30 minutes · open book.

2

Live Role Play (RP)

Individual, assessor-observed workplace conflict role play on LO2, LO3 and LO4 · 30 minutes.

3

Open book (WA)

You may use the course slides, the Learner Guide and approved materials.

4

Eligibility

A minimum of 75% attendance is required to be eligible for assessment and funding.

5

Result

Competent (C) or Not Yet Competent (NYC) — both instruments must be Competent.

6

Appeals

An appeal process is available if you wish to contest an assessment outcome.

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ON ASSESSMENT DAY

Assessment Flow



REMEMBER

TRAQOM, the assessment digital attendance and the signed Assessment Summary Record are all required — the Role Play is observed live by the assessor, the WA is submitted on the LMS.

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FUNDING

Criteria for Funding

1

Attendance

A minimum attendance rate of 75%, based on the SSG digital attendance record.

2

Assessment

Complete both assessment components and be assessed as Competent.

3

Digital attendance

Scan the SSG QR code for AM, PM and Assessment.

4

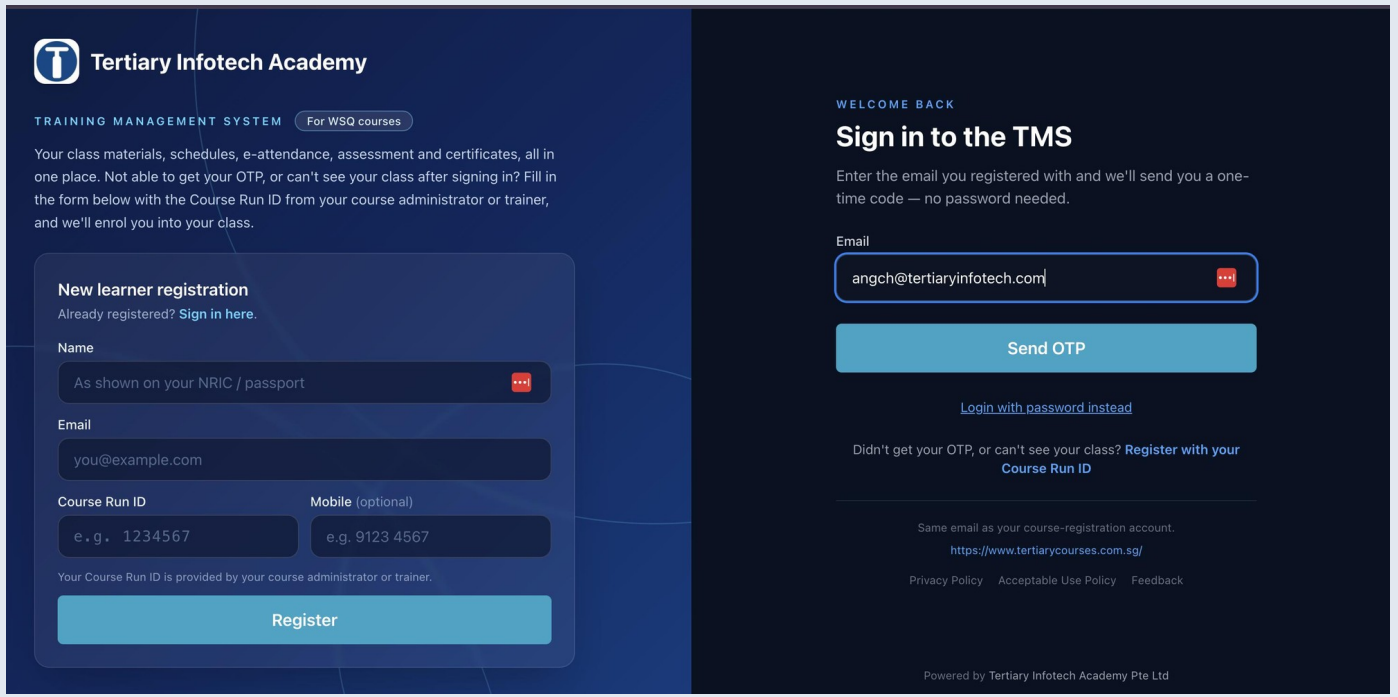
TRAQOM

Complete the mandatory TRAQOM step on the LMS.

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COURSE PORTAL · lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com

Login to LMS and Download Course Material



Sign in with your registered e-mail and the one-time code (OTP), then open this course.
https://lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com/

1. **Open the portal**
   lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com
2. **Send OTP**
   Use the e-mail you registered with
3. **Open this course**
   Conflict Management (TGS-2026066849)
4. **Download materials**
   Slides PDF, Learner Guide, activity packs
5. **Assessment day**
   Submit the WA on the LMS

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LEARNER RESOURCES

Activity Files for the Eight Workplace Cases

Every activity has its own folder with instructions, role cards, a worksheet and an observer checklist.

Option A · Browse online

Open the course repository and the labs/ folder; each Activity-NN folder is self-contained.

Option B · Download ZIP

On GitHub choose Code → Download ZIP, unzip, and open labs/README.md for the activity list.

Option C · From the LMS

Download the Learner Guide PDF — it repeats every activity's scenario, roles and steps.

COURSE REPOSITORY (click to open)

https://github.com/tertiarycourses/TGS-2026066849-Conflict-Management

Cases are fictional workplace simulations. Never disclose a real colleague's conflict; any participant may pause or switch roles.

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HOW TODAY FITS TOGETHER

The Conflict Management Playbook



ONE TOPIC PER MOVE

Topics 1 to 5 follow the playbook in order — each activity practises one move before the next builds on it.

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01

TOPIC 01 · LO1

Understanding Workplace Conflict and Management Styles

Conflict types · Escalation cycle · Warning signs · Thomas-Kilmann modes · Situational selection

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Key Concepts — Conflict & Management Styles

1

Conflict is a perceived threat

Conflict arises when a party perceives that important goals, interests, values, roles or resources are blocked — disagreement alone is not conflict.

2

Four conflict types

Task (what to do), process (how and who), relationship (how we treat each other) and values (what matters). Most real cases mix types.

3

Escalation cycle

Latent conditions become perceived, then felt, then manifest behaviour; the aftermath either repairs or reinforces the pattern.

4

Early warning signs

Silence, side-channel messages, missed handoffs, rework, withdrawal, complaints and declining service are data, not proof of blame.

5

Thomas-Kilmann modes

Competing, collaborating, compromising, avoiding and accommodating sit on two axes: assertiveness and cooperativeness.

6

Choose by situation

Select the mode from safety, stakes, relationship, power and voice, time and authority — never from habit or preference.

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Four Types of Workplace Conflict

Type	What it is about	Typical early signal	Useful first move
Task	What the work should be — goals, priorities, quality	Repeated debate on direction; rework	Clarify the goal and the evidence
Process	How and by whom — roles, handoffs, decision rights	Missed handoffs; 'not my job'	Map the workflow and decision rights
Relationship	How people treat each other — trust, respect	Avoidance, sarcasm, side channels	Separate people from the problem
Values	What matters — ethics, identity, fairness	Moral language; 'it's a matter of principle'	Find shared higher goals; respect limits

WHEN IT MATTERS Most real cases mix types. A process gap (no roster record) often grows into a relationship conflict — fix the process and the relationship can recover.

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Conflict Is Data Before It Becomes Damage

1

Communication

Silence, interruptions, sarcasm, messages that bypass normal channels.

2

Coordination

Missed handoffs, duplicated work, withheld information, reversed decisions.

3

People

Withdrawal, visible stress, cliques, absenteeism, requests to change teams.

4

Performance

Rework, delays, quality escapes, declining output.

5

Customers

Complaints, returned handoffs, inconsistent service.

6

Risk

Threats, harassment, discrimination or retaliation — escalate under policy.

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The Conflict Escalation Cycle

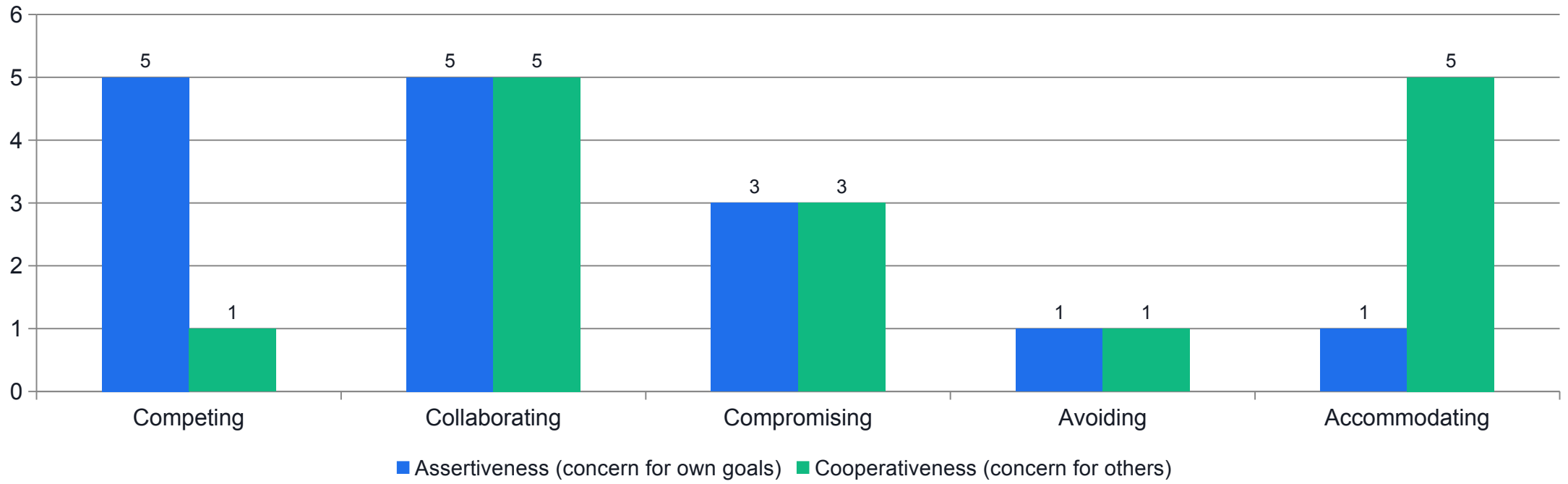


WHY IT MATTERS

A trigger — a public remark, an unfair roster, a missed deadline — moves conflict up a stage. Intervene at the earliest stage that evidence and safety allow.

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Thomas-Kilmann Modes on Two Dimensions



WHAT THE DATA SHOWS

Relative position of each mode on the Thomas-Kilmann model (1 = low, 5 = high) — not a measured score. Every mode is useful somewhere; the skill is choosing deliberately rather than defaulting to your favourite.

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Five Modes — Use Well, Overuse Badly

Mode	Helpful when…	Costly when overused…
Competing	Urgent safety or a non-negotiable standard	Used to protect ego or silence dissent
Collaborating	Important, interdependent issue with time	Applied to trivial issues — burns time
Compromising	Time pressure, equal power, divisible issue	Splits value before interests are explored
Avoiding	Cooling off; issue is trivial or not yours	A recurring fairness problem is ignored
Accommodating	Low-value preference; goodwill matters	Resentment builds; your needs disappear

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Selecting an Appropriate Approach



YES — compete within authority, then collaborate

Decide now to protect people or the standard; afterwards collaborate on the follow-up so the relationship is repaired.

NO — score the situation

High stakes + high relationship → collaborate. Time-critical, equal power → compromise. Low stakes → accommodate. Emotions high → avoid briefly, then return.

Situational criteria: safety · stakes · relationship · power and voice · time · authority. Score them before you choose a mode.

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LO1 · TOPIC 01 · ACTIVITY 1

Conflict Signal Triage at LionCity Retail

ACTIVITY 1 Case study · small-group analysis · 25 minutes

THE SITUATION

LionCity Retail's Orchard service team is preparing for a major promotion. Over three weeks, two experienced staff have repeatedly swapped shifts, team huddles have become quiet, and four customer handoffs were returned for missing information.

OBJECTIVE

Classify the conflict type and escalation stage from early warning signs, assess organisational impact and decide a safe first response.

YOU'LL PRODUCE

A signal log, a conflict-type and escalation-stage map, and a first-response decision with an escalation boundary.

MATERIALS

Signal log · conflict-type and stage map · triage matrix

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ACTIVITY 1 · ROLE CARDS

Scenario & Roles — LionCity Retail

Aisha privately tells supervisor Marcus that weekend duties are being allocated unfairly. Ben, the roster coordinator, says Aisha is refusing to cooperate. Marcus has only fragments of chat messages and no agreed roster-change record. The promotion starts in five days.

M

Marcus · Supervisor

GOAL

Protect service continuity and fairness.

BRIEF

Must decide what to clarify now and what requires escalation.

A

Aisha · Senior Associate

GOAL

Be heard without retaliation.

BRIEF

Believes a pattern — not one incident — shows unfair weekend allocation.

B

Ben · Roster Coordinator

GOAL

Defend operational decisions.

BRIEF

Says roster changes followed availability and were not personal.

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ACTIVITY 1 · PROCESS MAP

How Activity 1 Runs — 25 Minutes



THE POINT

Classify the conflict type and escalation stage from early warning signs, assess organisational impact and decide a safe first response.

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ACTIVITY 1 · PROCEDURE

Activity 1 Procedure — Step by Step

1. **Read for observable facts**
   Read the case once without discussing blame. Underline only what a person could directly see, hear, count or verify in a record.

2. **Separate claims and interpretations**
   Move reported claims to a second column and interpretations to a third. Rewrite labels such as 'uncooperative' as specific behaviour, context and frequency.

3. **Classify the conflict type**
   Decide whether each strand is task, process, relationship or values conflict. Note where types overlap — for example a process gap (no roster-change record) feeding a relationship strain.

4. **Map the escalation stage**
   Place the signals on the latent, perceived, felt and manifest stages and name the trigger that moved the conflict forward. Mark missing evidence as unknown.

5. **Assess organisational impact**
   Rate the current impact on people, work, customers and risk as low, medium or high, with one sentence of evidence for each rating.

6. **Screen immediate risk**
   Check for safety threats, harassment, discrimination, retaliation or serious misconduct. If any is present, stop informal handling and follow policy.

7. **Select the first response**
   Choose the least intrusive safe response — monitor, clarify separately, structured conversation, facilitation or formal escalation — and name the owner and deadline.

8. **Set the escalation boundary and brief**
   Write the trigger that would move the matter to HR or the grievance channel, then prepare a 60-second briefing that explains the decision without diagnosing anyone's personality.

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ACTIVITY 1 · DEBRIEF & CHECK

Debrief — Conflict Signal Triage at LionCity Retail

✅ **DEBRIEF STANDARD** The triage separates facts from assumptions, classifies type and stage with evidence, screens policy risk and selects a proportionate next action.

DISCUSS

- Which details are observable facts, reported claims and interpretations?
- Which conflict types are present, and which one is driving the others?
- What indicators suggest latent, perceived, felt or manifest conflict?
- What would make informal clarification unsafe or inappropriate?

IF THE GROUP GETS STUCK

Everything looks like 'attitude'

Ask: what would a camera have recorded? Rewrite each label as behaviour, context and frequency.

Group jumps to a joint meeting

Re-run the risk screen. A joint meeting is unsafe if retaliation or power concerns are unresolved.

Stage is unclear

Stages overlap. Record the earliest stage with evidence and the trigger that would move it forward.

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LO1 · TOPIC 01 · ACTIVITY 2

Conflict Style Choice Clinic at BrightWorks Digital

ACTIVITY 2 Case study · decision clinic · 25 minutes

THE SITUATION

BrightWorks Digital's product and sales teams disagree about releasing a feature before security testing is complete. Sales has promised a launch date to a key client; Product says the unresolved issue may expose customer data.

OBJECTIVE

Evaluate the five Thomas-Kilmann modes against situational criteria and justify a staged conflict-management approach.

YOU'LL PRODUCE

A Thomas-Kilmann style decision matrix with a staged response rationale (today and the next two weeks).

MATERIALS

Style decision matrix · situational criteria scorecard

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ACTIVITY 2 · ROLE CARDS

Scenario & Roles — BrightWorks Digital

The CEO wants a decision today, but both teams must work closely together for the next six months. Learners assess all five conflict-handling modes and recommend a staged response rather than declaring one style universally best.

HO

Head of Sales

GOAL

Keep the client's trust and the revenue commitment.

BRIEF

Under pressure from the account manager; open to a phased release if the client is informed early.

PL

Product Lead

GOAL

Protect customer data and product quality.

BRIEF

Will not release with an unresolved data-exposure risk; can scope a reduced feature set.

F

Facilitator · COO

GOAL

Reach a defensible decision and preserve collaboration.

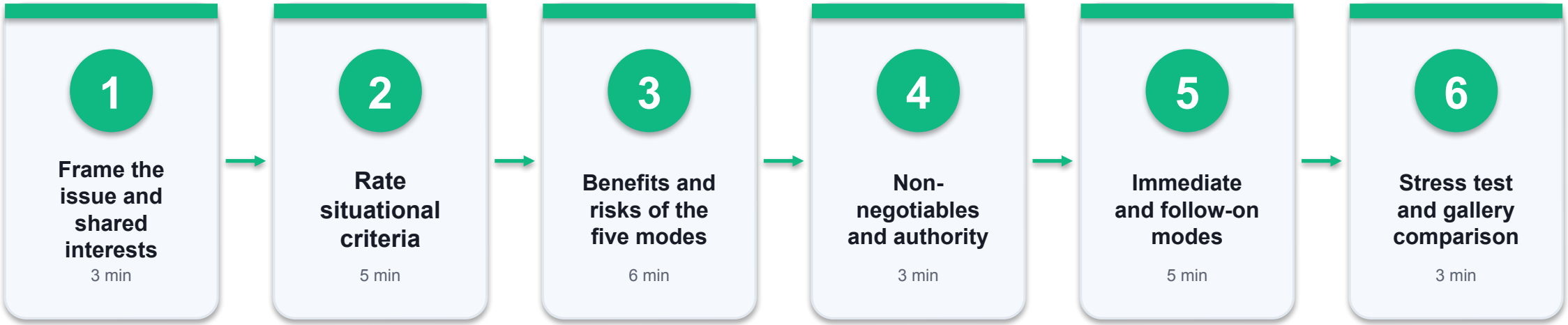
BRIEF

Has authority to decide today; must ensure both teams' expertise is heard.

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ACTIVITY 2 · PROCESS MAP

How Activity 2 Runs — 25 Minutes



THE POINT

Evaluate the five Thomas-Kilmann modes against situational criteria and justify a staged conflict-management approach.

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ACTIVITY 2 · PROCEDURE

Activity 2 Procedure — Step by Step

1. **Frame the issue**
   State the decision in one neutral sentence and list the shared interests: client trust, product value, data security and continued collaboration.

2. **Rate the situational criteria**
   Score safety, stakes, relationship importance, power and voice, time pressure and decision authority as low, medium or high, citing case evidence.

3. **Review the five modes**
   For competing, collaborating, compromising, avoiding and accommodating, write one potential benefit and one risk in this case.

4. **Identify non-negotiables**
   Name any legal, ethical, safety, security or policy threshold that cannot be traded for speed or harmony.

5. **Choose the immediate mode**
   Select the approach for today's deadline and explain who has authority and how dissenting expertise will still be heard.

6. **Choose the follow-on mode**
   Select the approach for the next two weeks so the urgent decision does not become the whole resolution.

7. **Protect voice**
   Add a mechanism for technical and commercial concerns to be raised without retaliation or domination by job title.

8. **Stress-test and compare**
   Test the plan against 'the client refuses a delay' and 'the CEO insists on release', then compare with another group to spot where personal preference replaced situational judgement.

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ACTIVITY 2 · DEBRIEF & CHECK

Debrief — Conflict Style Choice Clinic at BrightWorks Digital

✅ **DEBRIEF STANDARD** The recommendation links each mode choice to evidence about safety, stakes, relationship, power, time and authority, and stages the response.

DISCUSS

- Which part of the issue is non-negotiable, and who has authority to decide it?
- Where would collaborating add value after the immediate decision?
- What power imbalance or voice risk must the facilitator manage?
- What temporary agreement could protect the client relationship without compromising security?

IF THE GROUP GETS STUCK

'Collaborate' for everything

Collaboration needs time and shared goals. Ask what must be decided today and by whom.

Security traded for speed

Return to the non-negotiables list — a data-exposure risk is not a bargaining chip.

No follow-on plan

Add a second stage: who meets, when, and how the relationship cost of today's decision is repaired.

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TOPIC 01 · WHY IT MATTERS

Diagnose the conflict before you choose the style.

Type and stage tell you what is happening; situational criteria tell you which mode fits.

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Recap — Conflict & Management Styles

1

Activity 1 · LionCity Retail

You can now: classify the conflict type and escalation stage from early warning signs, assess organisational impact and decide a safe first response.

2

Activity 2 · BrightWorks Digital

You can now: evaluate the five Thomas-Kilmann modes against situational criteria and justify a staged conflict-management approach.

3

LO1

Analyse workplace conflict types, escalation stages, and management styles to select appropriate conflict resolution approaches for organisational settings.

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02

TOPIC 02 · LO2

Communication Techniques for Diffusing Tensions

Active listening · Empathy · Reframing · Neutral language · Non-verbal cues · Self-regulation

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Key Concepts — Communication & De-escalation

1

Active listening

Attend, ask open questions, paraphrase, reflect emotion and summarise — understanding is demonstrated, not assumed.

2

Empathy is not agreement

Validating a person's experience acknowledges it as real for them without deciding that every claim is correct.

3

Perspective-taking

Ask what the other person sees, fears and needs; it surfaces interests that a rebuttal would bury.

4

Reframing

Translate blame and labels into observable behaviour, impact, underlying interest and a future-focused request.

5

Non-verbal signals

Tone, pace, posture, eye contact, proximity and silence carry most of the emotional message — align them with your words.

6

Regulation first

Notice your own triggers, slow the pace and pause where safe — a flooded brain cannot problem-solve.

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The Active Listening Loop



CHECK, DON'T ASSUME

Each loop ends with a check — 'Have I got that right?' Understanding is something you demonstrate, not something you claim.

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Questions That Open vs Questions That Close

Closing / accusatory	Open / exploratory	Why it works
Why did you ignore the procedure?	Walk me through the handoff from your side.	Invites an account, not a defence
Who started this?	What happened just before the argument?	Explores sequence, not blame
Don't you think Priya overreacted?	What impact did this have on your work?	Neutral — no leading premise
Can you prove you are right?	What would a workable week look like for you?	Moves to interests and future

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Empathy and Perspective-Taking

1

Notice emotional cues

Pace, volume, word choice and what is not said signal the emotion behind the words.

2

Validate, don't verdict

'That sounds frustrating' acknowledges experience without agreeing with every claim.

3

Take their perspective

Ask: what do they see, fear and need? Write it in their words before your own.

4

Check your own story

Separate what you observed from the motive you assumed.

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Reframing Blame into Interests

Escalating statement	Neutral reframe	Interest surfaced
He keeps changing priorities without warning.	Priorities changed late without notice to the pickers.	Predictability and safe planning
Her team hides delays.	Picking delays become visible only late in the day.	Early warning to protect customers
Taylor shoots down everything I say.	You need to finish presenting before critique starts.	Fair hearing for ideas
This always happens.	This has happened three times this month.	A pattern worth fixing

WHEN IT MATTERS Separate the person from the problem: describe the behaviour and its impact, never the character.

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Non-Verbal Communication in Conflict

1. **Posture**
   Open, seated, angled slightly — not squared off or towering.

2. **Eye contact**
   Steady but soft; culturally sensitive, never a stare-down.

3. **Tone and pace**
   Lower and slower than theirs pulls the conversation down.

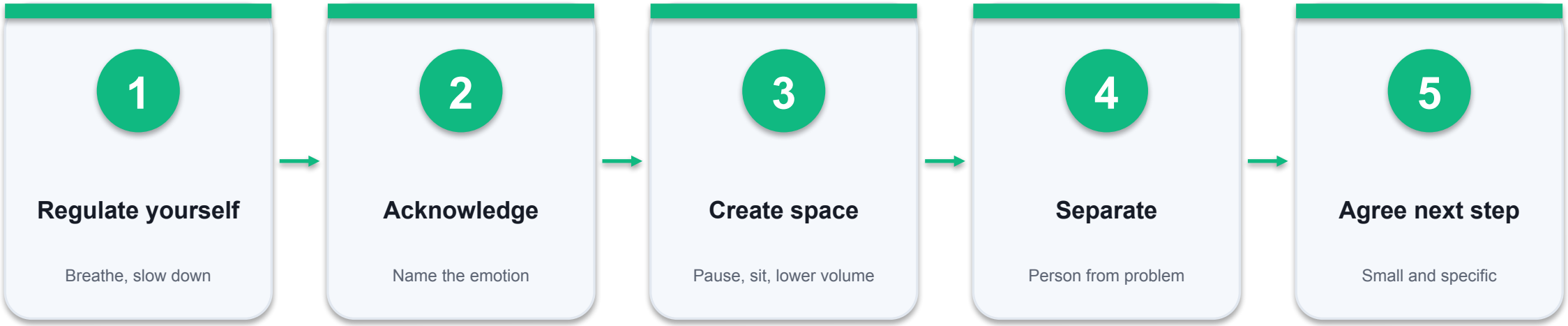
4. **Space**
   Respect personal distance; sit side-by-side on shared documents.

5. **Face and hands**
   Relaxed face, visible hands; no eye-rolling or pointing.

6. **Silence**
   A pause lets emotion settle and invites the other person to continue.

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A De-escalation Sequence



SAFETY FIRST

If there is any threat of harm, stop the conversation, protect people and follow the safety procedure — de-escalation is not a substitute.

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Active Listening and Reframing at HarborLink Logistics

ACTIVITY 3 Role play · triads with observer · 35 minutes

THE SITUATION

At HarborLink Logistics, warehouse lead Priya raised her voice at transport planner Daniel during the morning huddle, saying he 'keeps changing dispatch priorities without warning'. Daniel replied that Priya's team 'hides picking delays until late afternoon' and walked out.

OBJECTIVE

Apply active listening, empathy, reframing and non-verbal techniques to de-escalate a tense conversation and agree a next step.

YOU'LL PRODUCE

A listening log with paraphrases, emotion reflections and reframes, plus an observer's de-escalation sheet and an agreed next step.

MATERIALS

Listening log · reframing table · non-verbal observation sheet

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ACTIVITY 3 · ROLE CARDS

Scenario & Roles — HarborLink Logistics

Operations supervisor Siew Ling meets each of them separately the same morning. The shared dashboard records timestamps but not who approved priority changes. Siew Ling's goal is not to decide who is right, but to lower the temperature, understand each person's interests and agree a calm next step.

SL

Siew Ling · Operations Supervisor

GOAL

Lower the temperature and understand both sides.

BRIEF

Listens, paraphrases, reflects emotion, reframes blame and agrees a next step — without taking sides.

P

Priya · Warehouse Lead

GOAL

Be taken seriously about last-minute changes.

BRIEF

Frustrated and embarrassed about raising her voice; worried about overtime and safe picking.

D

Daniel · Transport Planner

GOAL

Meet urgent delivery commitments.

BRIEF

Feels blamed in public; has three customer escalations this week and believes delays are hidden.

O

Observer

GOAL

Give evidence-based feedback.

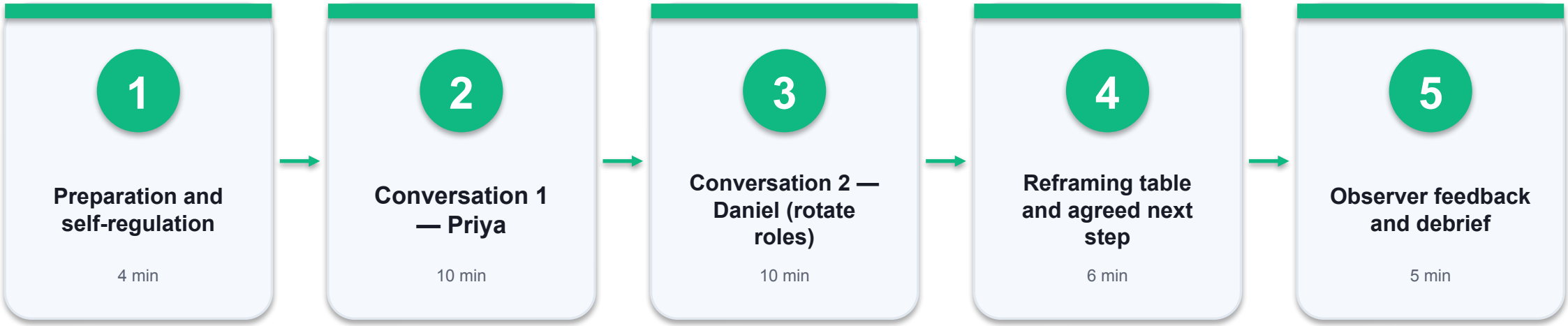
BRIEF

Logs listening moves and non-verbal cues — tone, pace, posture, eye contact, interruptions.

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ACTIVITY 3 · PROCESS MAP

How Activity 3 Runs — 35 Minutes



THE POINT

Apply active listening, empathy, reframing and non-verbal techniques to de-escalate a tense conversation and agree a next step.

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ACTIVITY 3 · PROCEDURE

Activity 3 Procedure — Step by Step

1. **Prepare yourself**
   Siew Ling notes her own reaction to the incident, chooses a private seated setting, sets a 10-minute window and plans an open, relaxed posture.

2. **Open neutrally**
   State the purpose (understand what happened and agree a next step), respectful conduct and the limits of confidentiality. Avoid any verdict.

3. **Invite the account**
   Ask one open question — 'Walk me through this morning from your side' — then listen for two minutes without interrupting, using minimal encouragers.

4. **Paraphrase the content**
   Restate the facts in your own words and check: 'So the priorities changed twice after 10am and nobody told the pickers — have I got that right?'

5. **Reflect the emotion**
   Name the feeling tentatively and validate it without agreeing with every claim: 'It sounds frustrating to be blamed for delays you didn't cause.'

6. **Explore with open questions**
   Ask about impact, needs and perspective: 'What do you need from transport to plan picking safely?' 'How might Daniel be seeing this?'

7. **Reframe blame into interests**
   Convert accusations into behaviour, impact, interest and request, and record each pair in the reframing table.

8. **Watch and adjust non-verbal cues**
   The observer signals if tone, pace, posture or eye contact escalate; the listener slows down, lowers volume and leaves silence.

9. **Summarise and agree a next step**
   Summarise interests and agree one concrete next step — for example a 15-minute joint check-in with a shared change-log template.

10. **Rotate and debrief**
    Repeat with Daniel (new listener), then the observer gives one strong move and one missed opportunity per conversation.

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ACTIVITY 3 · DEBRIEF & CHECK

Debrief — Active Listening and Reframing at HarborLink Logistics

✅ **DEBRIEF STANDARD** Both conversations show accurate paraphrasing, emotion reflection, neutral reframes and calm non-verbal behaviour, ending with an agreed, specific next step.

DISCUSS

- Which listening move lowered the temperature most, and why?
- How did you validate emotion without agreeing with every claim?
- Which reframe turned blame into a shared problem?
- What non-verbal signals escalated or calmed the conversation?

IF THE GROUP GETS STUCK

Listener starts problem-solving

Pause. Paraphrase and reflect first — solutions offered too early sound like a verdict.

Speaker escalates

Lower volume and pace, acknowledge the emotion, offer a short pause; do not argue facts while flooded.

Reframe sounds like spin

Keep the speaker's meaning. A reframe names their real need, not a softer version of what you prefer.

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TOPIC 02 · WHY IT MATTERS

Regulation precedes resolution.

A calm, heard person can problem-solve. A flooded, defended one cannot — listen first.

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TOPIC 02 · RECAP

Recap — Communication & De-escalation

1

Activity 3 · HarborLink Logistics

You can now: apply active listening, empathy, reframing and non-verbal techniques to de-escalate a tense conversation and agree a next step.

2

LO2

Apply active listening, empathy, reframing, and non-verbal communication techniques to de-escalate and manage conflict conversations effectively.

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TOPIC 03 · LO3

Negotiation and Consensus-Building Strategies

Positions · Interests · BATNA · Reservation points · ZOPA · Option generation · Resistance · Consensus

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Key Concepts — Negotiation & Consensus

1

Positions vs interests

A position is the demand; the interest is the reason. Interests are usually more numerous and more compatible than positions.

2

BATNA

Your Best Alternative To a Negotiated Agreement — what you will do if talks fail. It sets your real negotiating power.

3

Reservation point & ZOPA

The reservation point is the worst deal you would accept; the Zone of Possible Agreement is where both parties' limits overlap.

4

Expand before you divide

Generate several packages that trade across differing priorities before anyone evaluates or concedes.

5

Resistance and power

Name the impasse, return to interests and objective criteria, and protect the voice of the less powerful party.

6

Consensus and commitment

Test agreement explicitly, word it as specific actions, owners and dates, and secure visible commitment.

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Position Bargaining vs Interest-Based Negotiation

Dimension	Position bargaining	Interest-based negotiation
Focus	Argues for a fixed demand	Explores needs and constraints beneath it
Value	Treats every concession as a loss	Trades across differing priorities
Basis	Power, pressure, persistence	Objective criteria and evidence
Relationship	Often damaged	Protected for future work
Outcome	Split the difference	Packages that meet more interests

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TOPIC 03 · NEGOTIATION ANALYTICS

BATNA, Reservation Point and ZOPA

1

Position

The stated demand — 'two extra nurses per session'.

2

Interest

The reason underneath — patient safety, staff recovery, budget.

3

BATNA

Best Alternative To a Negotiated Agreement — what you do if talks fail.

4

Reservation point

The worst deal you will accept before walking away to your BATNA.

5

ZOPA

Zone of Possible Agreement — where both reservation points overlap.

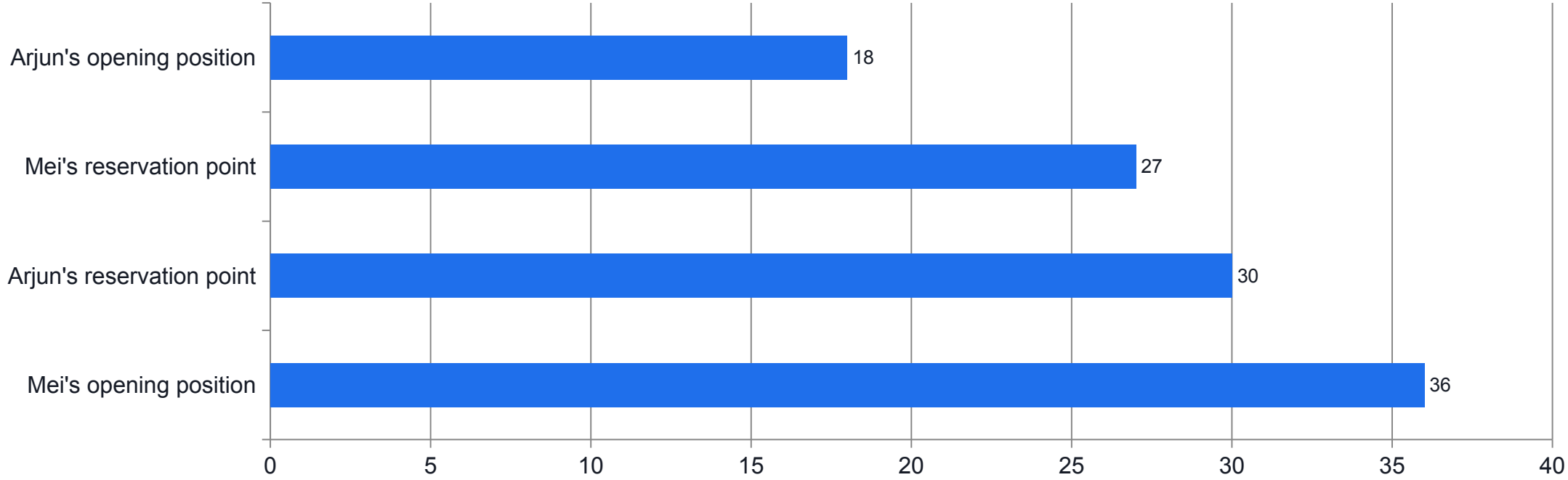
6

Power

The stronger your BATNA, the less you need any particular deal.

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Worked Example — Finding the ZOPA at CarePoint

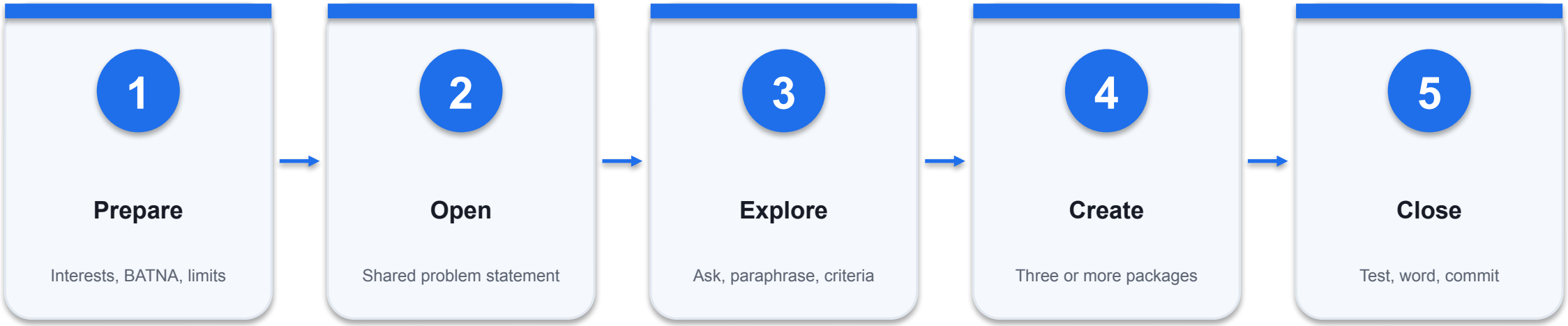


WHAT THE DATA SHOWS

Openings are 18 vs 36 hours — far apart. But Mei can accept 27 and Arjun can approve up to 30, so a ZOPA of 27–30 nurse-hours exists. Interests and criteria help both find it.

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Interest-Based Negotiation in Five Moves



EXPAND BEFORE YOU DIVIDE

Generate options before evaluating them — brainstorming and evaluation in the same breath kills creativity.

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Overcoming Resistance, Power Imbalance and Impasse

1

Name the impasse

'We seem stuck on the budget — can we step back to what each of us needs?'

2

Return to criteria

Ask which objective standard would make an option fair to both sides.

3

Make it conditional

Pilot, phase or trigger-based commitments lower the risk of saying yes.

4

Balance power

Time-box turns, invite the quieter party, check authority on both sides.

5

Take a break

A short pause resets emotion; agree exactly when you will resume.

6

Know your BATNA

If no ZOPA exists, escalate with data rather than concede below your limit.

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Testing Consensus — Gradients of Agreement

Level	What the person means	What to do
1 · Endorse	I fully support this	Record commitment
2 · Agree	I can live with it comfortably	Record commitment
3 · Reservations	I'll go along but have a concern	Ask for the concern; adjust if cheap
4 · Serious concern	I need changes before I commit	Return to interests and options
5 · Block	I cannot accept this	Do not close — rework or escalate

WHEN IT MATTERS Word the agreement as actions, owners, dates, evidence and a review trigger — then ask each party to confirm it aloud.

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Interest-Based Negotiation at CarePoint Clinics

ACTIVITY 4 Role play · negotiation pairs with observer · 40 minutes

THE SITUATION

CarePoint Clinics must cover three six-hour Saturday vaccination sessions during a seasonal surge. Nurse lead Mei wants two extra nurses at each session (36 extra nurse-hours); operations lead Arjun says the overtime ceiling permits only one (18 nurse-hours).

OBJECTIVE

Negotiate a staffing agreement using interests, BATNA, reservation points and objective criteria, overcome an impasse and test consensus.

YOU'LL PRODUCE

A negotiation canvas (positions, interests, BATNA, reservation point), an option scorecard and a consensus-tested written agreement.

MATERIALS

Negotiation canvas · ZOPA line · option scorecard · agreement template

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ACTIVITY 4 · ROLE CARDS

Scenario & Roles — CarePoint Clinics

Both need safe patient care and sustainable staffing. Each receives private interests, a BATNA and a reservation point, then negotiates a package using booking forecasts, skill coverage, overtime limits and rotation history. Midway, Arjun announces that 'head office will not approve a cent more' — the pair must work through the impasse.

M · Mei · Nurse Lead

GOAL

Protect patient safety and staff recovery.

BRIEF

Reservation point: 27 extra nurse-hours (minimum safe coverage). BATNA: cap bookings at 75% and turn patients away. Can trade session length and skill mix, not minimum clinical coverage.

A · Arjun · Operations Lead

GOAL

Stay within approved cost and service commitments.

BRIEF

Reservation point: 30 extra nurse-hours with evidence of demand. BATNA: hire agency nurses at about 1.6 times the cost. Can reallocate weekday hours and seek conditional approval.

O · Observer · Process Coach

GOAL

Test fairness and process quality.

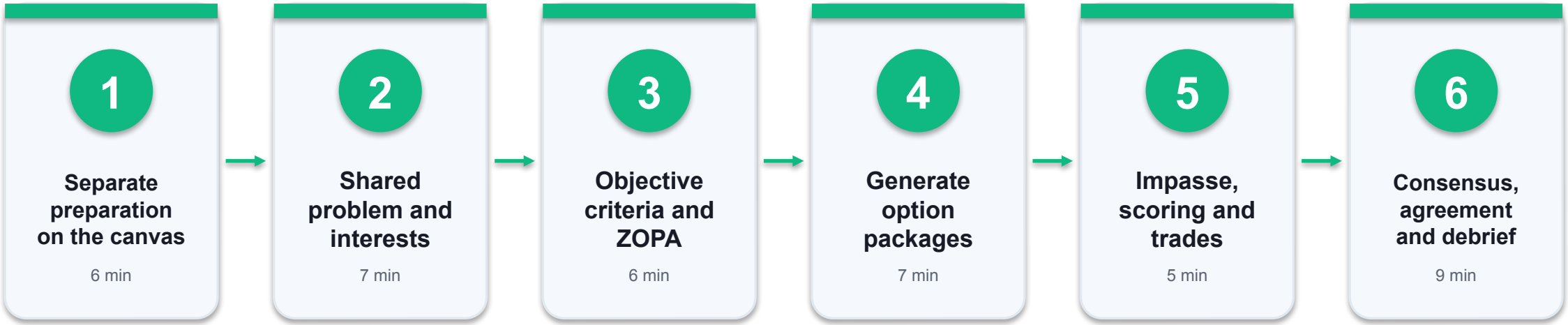
BRIEF

Tracks questions, paraphrases, criteria, options, impasse handling and how consensus was tested.

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ACTIVITY 4 · PROCESS MAP

How Activity 4 Runs — 40 Minutes



THE POINT

Negotiate a staffing agreement using interests, BATNA, reservation points and objective criteria, overcome an impasse and test consensus.

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ACTIVITY 4 · PROCEDURE

Activity 4 Procedure — Step by Step

1. **Prepare separately**
   Each party fills in the canvas: position, underlying interests, BATNA, reservation point, evidence and what they could trade.

2. **Agree a shared problem statement**
   Convert the dispute into a joint question: 'How do we cover the surge safely within a sustainable cost?'

3. **Exchange interests**
   Each side explains interests and constraints; the other paraphrases before responding. No proposals yet.

4. **Agree objective criteria**
   Choose criteria both accept — booking forecast, minimum clinical ratio, overtime policy, cost and fair rotation.

5. **Locate the ZOPA**
   Without revealing reservation points verbatim, test ranges until both see whether an overlap exists (here 27–30 nurse-hours).

6. **Generate at least three packages**
   Combine variables — session length, skill mix, weekday hour swaps, staggered start times, a pilot — before evaluating any of them.

7. **Work through the impasse**
   When Arjun's 'not a cent more' lands, name the impasse, return to interests and criteria, propose a conditional or phased package, and protect Mei's voice if power tilts.

8. **Score and trade**
   Rate each package against the agreed criteria; trade low-cost/high-value items without trading away safety or policy.

9. **Test consensus**
   Use a gradients-of-agreement check (1 = fully endorse … 5 = cannot accept); resolve any 4–5 before closing.

10. **Word the agreement**
    Record the allocation, actions, owners, dates, evidence, communication to staff and a review trigger; both parties confirm commitment.

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ACTIVITY 4 · DEBRIEF & CHECK

Debrief — Interest-Based Negotiation at CarePoint Clinics

✅ **DEBRIEF STANDARD** The agreement sits inside the ZOPA, explains interests, criteria and trade-offs, survived an impasse and was consensus-tested with owners, dates and a review trigger.

DISCUSS

- What are each party's positions, interests, BATNA and reservation point?
- Is there a ZOPA — and what would you do if there were none?
- Which package trades across time, skill mix, session design and budget?
- How did you handle 'not a cent more' without escalating the conflict?

IF THE GROUP GETS STUCK

Splitting the difference at once

Stop. Compromise before exploring interests leaves value on the table — generate packages first.

No overlap found

Re-check BATNAs and add variables (timing, pilot, conditional approval); if still none, escalate with data.

One party dominates

Use the observer to time-box turns, paraphrase the quieter party and return to the agreed criteria.

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TOPIC 03 · WHY IT MATTERS

Interests are compatible more often than positions.

Ask why before you argue how much — then let objective criteria choose between packages.

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TOPIC 03 · RECAP

Recap — Negotiation & Consensus

1

Activity 4 · CarePoint Clinics

You can now: negotiate a staffing agreement using interests, BATNA, reservation points and objective criteria, overcome an impasse and test consensus.

2

LO3

Apply interest-based negotiation and consensus-building techniques to facilitate collaborative problem-solving and overcome resistance among conflicting parties.

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04

TOPIC 04 · LO4

Achieving Resolution and Protecting Organisational Interests

Structured resolution process · Mediation stages · Impartiality · Option evaluation · Action planning

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Key Concepts — Resolution & Mediation

1

Structured process

Intake → issue mapping → option development → evaluation → agreement and follow-up keeps resolution fair and repeatable.

2

Mediator owns the process

A mediator manages fairness, voice and structure — never the outcome. Parties craft and own their agreement.

3

Boundary management

Check suitability, voluntariness, power and policy limits first; harassment or discrimination concerns go to the formal route.

4

Evaluate every option

Test options against policy fit, risk, fairness to all parties and the organisation's goals — not just the parties' comfort.

5

Actionable plans

Every agreement names the action, owner, date, evidence of progress and a review point or trigger.

6

Document proportionately

Record what is necessary, accurate and authorised; restrict access on a need-to-know basis.

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A Structured Conflict-Resolution Process

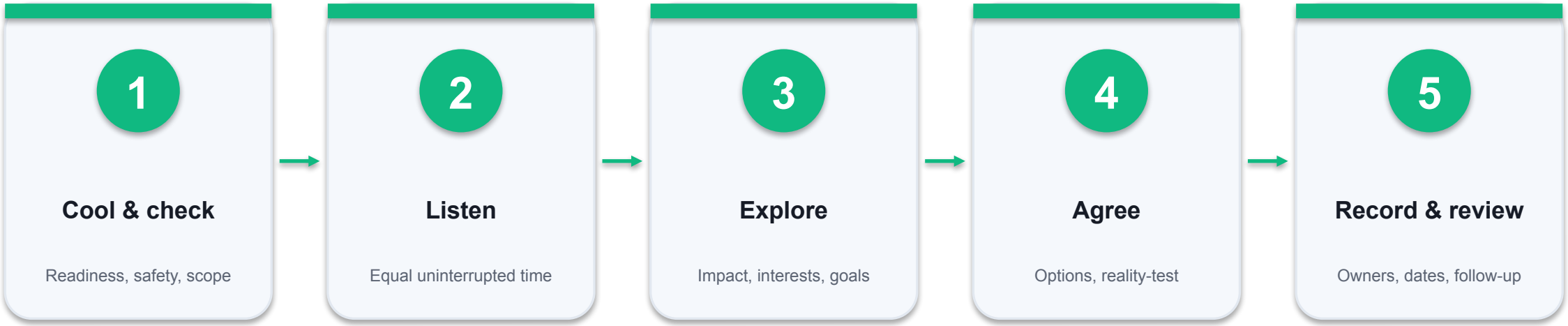


REPEATABLE AND FAIR

The same stages for every case make outcomes defensible — and stop the loudest party from setting the agenda.

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The Stages of Mediation



THE MEDIATOR OWNS THE PROCESS

Parties own the outcome. A mediator who proposes the answer stops being neutral.

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Impartial Facilitation and Boundary Management

1. **Suitability**
   Voluntary, no alleged harassment, discrimination or threat, workable power balance.

2. **Equal voice**
   Comparable time, questions and opportunity to respond.

3. **Neutral language**
   Balanced summaries; reframes that keep both meanings.

4. **Confidentiality limits**
   Explain what can and cannot be kept private — never promise total secrecy.

5. **Authority limits**
   Know what the organisation can offer and what needs a decision-maker.

6. **Stop rules**
   Pause or end if safety, coercion or a formal-process issue appears.

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Evaluating Resolution Options

Criterion	Question to ask	Red flag
Policy fit	Is it consistent with our policies and the law?	Bypasses a grievance or HR process
Risk	What could go wrong for safety, clients or reputation?	Shifts risk onto a third party
Fairness	Would a neutral observer see it as fair to both?	One party carries all the change
Organisational goals	Does it support service, quality and teamwork?	Solves the feeling, not the work
Feasibility	Can it be done with the time and resources we have?	No owner, budget or date

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TOPIC 04 · BOUNDARY DECISION

Mediate, or Route to the Formal Process?



YES — formal route under policy

Protect people, preserve evidence, route to HR or the grievance channel, ensure non-retaliation. Do not 'clear the air'.

NO — mediation may fit

If participation is voluntary and power is workable, mediate with ground rules and a written, reviewable agreement.

This course gives management guidance, not legal advice — apply your organisation's policy and seek professional advice for real cases.

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Action Planning, Accountability and Documentation

1. **Specific action**
   An observable behaviour or change — not 'communicate better'.

2. **Owner and date**
   One named owner per action and a realistic deadline.

3. **Evidence of progress**
   What we will see if it is working.

4. **Review point**
   A follow-up date and the trigger for re-opening.

5. **Proportionate records**
   Necessary, accurate, authorised; restricted to need-to-know.

6. **Follow-up**
   Check in with both parties — silence is not success.

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LO4 · TOPIC 04 · ACTIVITY 5

Mediated Conversation at Mosaic Creative

ACTIVITY 5 Role play · mediation triads with observer · 35 minutes

THE SITUATION

At Mosaic Creative, designer Alex says reviewer Taylor undermines ideas in client-preparation meetings by interrupting with risks. Taylor says Alex dismisses feedback and presents concepts too late for proper review. Two client pitches have slipped this quarter.

OBJECTIVE

Run a structured mediation, evaluate options against policy, risk, fairness and organisational goals, and record an actionable agreement.

YOU'LL PRODUCE

A mediation record (ground rules, issue map, options, evaluation matrix) and a written action plan with owners, dates, evidence and review.

MATERIALS

Mediation record · option evaluation matrix · action-plan template · observer checklist

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ACTIVITY 5 · ROLE CARDS

Scenario & Roles — Mosaic Creative

Their manager Jordan will mediate. The shared goal is better client work without silencing critique. The issue is suitable for mediation: there is no allegation of harassment, discrimination or threat, and both parties agree to take part.

J · Jordan · Mediator

GOAL

Run a fair process.

BRIEF

Checks suitability, sets ground rules, paraphrases, reframes, reality-tests and records the agreement — never decides who is right.

A · Alex · Designer

GOAL

Receive fair consideration.

BRIEF

Needs time to present ideas and feedback focused on the work, not competence.

T · Taylor · Reviewer

GOAL

Surface risk early.

BRIEF

Needs concerns heard and evidence considered before client exposure.

O · Observer

GOAL

Assess impartiality and structure.

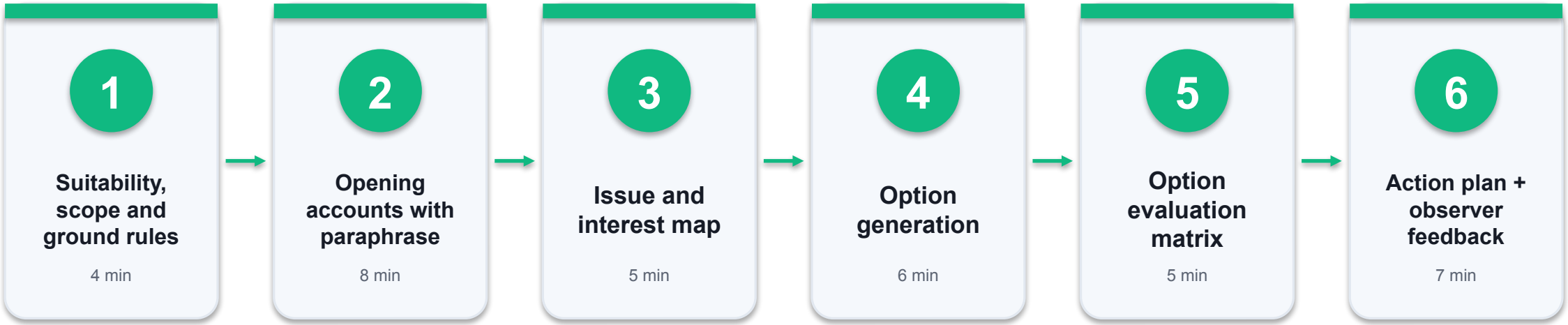
BRIEF

Uses the checklist to track equal voice, neutrality and agreement quality.

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ACTIVITY 5 · PROCESS MAP

How Activity 5 Runs — 35 Minutes



THE POINT

Run a structured mediation, evaluate options against policy, risk, fairness and organisational goals, and record an actionable agreement.

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ACTIVITY 5 · PROCEDURE

Activity 5 Procedure — Step by Step

1. **Confirm suitability**
   Jordan checks voluntary participation, readiness, power balance and that no allegation requires a formal process instead.
2. **State scope and limits**
   Explain the mediator's neutral role, respectful conduct, note-taking and the limits of confidentiality; parties confirm the issue to discuss.
3. **Agree ground rules**
   One speaker at a time, specific recent examples, no insults, permission to pause, focus on future work.
4. **Hear both accounts**
   Alex then Taylor each speak for two uninterrupted minutes; Jordan paraphrases facts, feelings and needs, and the other party checks understanding.
5. **Map issues and interests**
   Jordan lists the issues neutrally (timing of reviews, how critique is given) and the interests behind each position.
6. **Generate options**
   Each party proposes at least two options without evaluation; Jordan adds what the organisation can support.
7. **Evaluate options**
   Score options against policy fit, risk to client delivery, fairness to both parties and team goals; drop or adjust any that fail.
8. **Write the action plan**
   Record the critique protocol, presentation time, language expectations, owners, dates, evidence of progress and a two-week review.
9. **Observer feedback**
   The observer names one strong mediation move and one missed opportunity, and checks the plan is specific and balanced.

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ACTIVITY 5 · DEBRIEF & CHECK

Debrief — Mediated Conversation at Mosaic Creative

✅ **DEBRIEF STANDARD** The mediation follows the structured stages, stays impartial, evaluates options against organisational criteria and ends with a balanced, observable action plan.

DISCUSS

What opening establishes purpose, neutrality and the limits of confidentiality?

How did Jordan stay impartial while validating both perspectives?

Which option scored best against policy, risk, fairness and goals — and why?

What would make the agreement fail, and how does the plan detect it early?

IF THE GROUP GETS STUCK

Mediator takes a side

Return to balanced summaries; give the other party comparable time and an equivalent question.

Options are vague

Ask 'what will we see differently at the next review?' and add an owner and date.

Party wants a verdict

Restate the mediator's role: the process is shared, the decision is theirs within policy limits.

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LO4 · TOPIC 04 · ACTIVITY 6

Policy, Ethics and Escalation at Meridian Hospitality

ACTIVITY 6 Case study · routing decision · 20 minutes

THE SITUATION

At Meridian Hospitality, employee Farah reports that colleague Leon has repeatedly made jokes about her religion in a team chat. She fears that complaining will affect her shift allocation because Leon is close to the duty manager.

OBJECTIVE

Decide when mediation is inappropriate, route a concern to the correct policy channel and protect people, evidence and confidentiality.

YOU'LL PRODUCE

An escalation decision record with the routing choice, interim protection plan, confidentiality boundary and a neutral acknowledgement message.

MATERIALS

Policy-routing worksheet · evidence and privacy checklist

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ACTIVITY 6 · ROLE CARDS

Scenario & Roles — Meridian Hospitality

A supervisor, Ravi, suggests putting both employees in a room to 'clear the air'. Learners decide the immediate response, the authorised channel, the confidentiality boundary, interim support and documentation. This activity is educational and not legal advice.

F

Farah · Reporting Employee

GOAL

Be safe, heard and protected from retaliation.

BRIEF

Wants the conduct to stop; anxious about who will see the report.

R

Ravi · Supervisor

GOAL

Respond promptly within his authority.

BRIEF

Must not investigate beyond competence or force a face-to-face meeting.

HC

HR Case Lead

GOAL

Run a fair policy process.

BRIEF

Explains scope, privacy, support, neutral fact-finding and next updates.

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ACTIVITY 6 · PROCESS MAP

How Activity 6 Runs — 20 Minutes



THE POINT

Decide when mediation is inappropriate, route a concern to the correct policy channel and protect people, evidence and confidentiality.

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ACTIVITY 6 · PROCEDURE

Activity 6 Procedure — Step by Step

1. **Read without investigating**
   Identify only the immediate routing decision; do not try to prove or disprove the allegation.

2. **Identify risk categories**
   Mark possible harassment, discrimination, retaliation and data-protection concerns as issues to check, not findings.

3. **Decide mediation suitability**
   Explain why 'clearing the air' is not the default: alleged discriminatory conduct and a power imbalance call for the formal route.

4. **Choose the route**
   Select the designated policy owner (HR or the grievance channel) and an alternative route because the duty manager may be conflicted.

5. **Plan interim protection**
   Agree proportionate support and anti-retaliation monitoring that does not penalise the reporter (for example no unfavourable roster change).

6. **Protect evidence and confidentiality**
   Preserve the chat records, limit access to need-to-know, and never promise complete secrecy.

7. **Draft the acknowledgement**
   Write a short neutral message: receipt, immediate step, next process step, contact person, confidentiality limit and non-retaliation expectation.

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ACTIVITY 6 · DEBRIEF & CHECK

Debrief — Policy, Ethics and Escalation at Meridian Hospitality

✅ **DEBRIEF STANDARD** The response routes the concern to the correct policy channel, protects safety and fairness, limits data access and defines non-retaliation follow-up.

DISCUSS

- Why is immediate informal mediation inappropriate here?
- What can Ravi promise — and not promise — about confidentiality?
- Which records are necessary, and who should be able to see them?
- How will you detect and prevent retaliation in the coming weeks?

IF THE GROUP GETS STUCK

Group starts investigating

Stop at routing. Fact-finding belongs to the impartial owner named in policy.

Promises total secrecy

Replace with 'shared only with those who need to know to handle it fairly'.

Interim step penalises Farah

Re-check: protective measures must not disadvantage the person who reported.

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TOPIC 04 · WHY IT MATTERS

A fair process protects the people and the organisation.

Check the boundary, run the stages, evaluate against policy and goals — then write it down and review it.

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Recap — Resolution & Mediation

1

Activity 5 · Mosaic Creative

You can now: run a structured mediation, evaluate options against policy, risk, fairness and organisational goals, and record an actionable agreement.

2

Activity 6 · Meridian Hospitality

You can now: decide when mediation is inappropriate, route a concern to the correct policy channel and protect people, evidence and confidentiality.

3

LO4

Evaluate and apply structured conflict resolution and mediation frameworks to develop actionable plans aligned with organisational goals.

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05

TOPIC 05 · LO5

Sustaining a Conflict-Resilient Organisation

Guidelines · Escalation protocols · Psychological safety · Root-cause review · Monitoring and review

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Key Concepts — Conflict-Resilient Organisation

1

Written guidelines

A conflict-management guideline sets scope, roles, channels, timelines, confidentiality and non-retaliation.

2

Tiered escalation

Clear tiers — self-resolution, line manager, HR or neutral facilitator, formal grievance, external advice — remove guesswork.

3

Psychological safety

Leaders who invite dissent, respond without punishment and close the loop make early, constructive conflict possible.

4

Root-cause review

Recurring conflict usually signals a system cause — decision rights, handoffs, incentives or workload — not one difficult person.

5

Monitor balanced indicators

Track behaviour, process, work results, people experience and risk; silence is not evidence of success.

6

Review periodically

Schedule reviews of cases, trends and the guideline itself; update controls when the evidence changes.

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What a Conflict-Management Guideline Contains

1. **Purpose and scope**
   Which disagreements it covers and which go straight to formal policy.

2. **Roles**
   Employee, line manager, HR, neutral facilitator and decision-maker.

3. **Channels**
   How to raise a concern, including an alternative to the direct manager.

4. **Timelines**
   Acknowledge, act and review within stated time frames.

5. **Confidentiality**
   Need-to-know handling, record-keeping and data protection.

6. **Non-retaliation**
   Protection for those who raise, support or take part.

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A Tiered Escalation Protocol



SKIP TIERS WHEN SAFETY REQUIRES

Harassment, discrimination, threats or retaliation go straight to the formal tier — the protocol must say so explicitly.

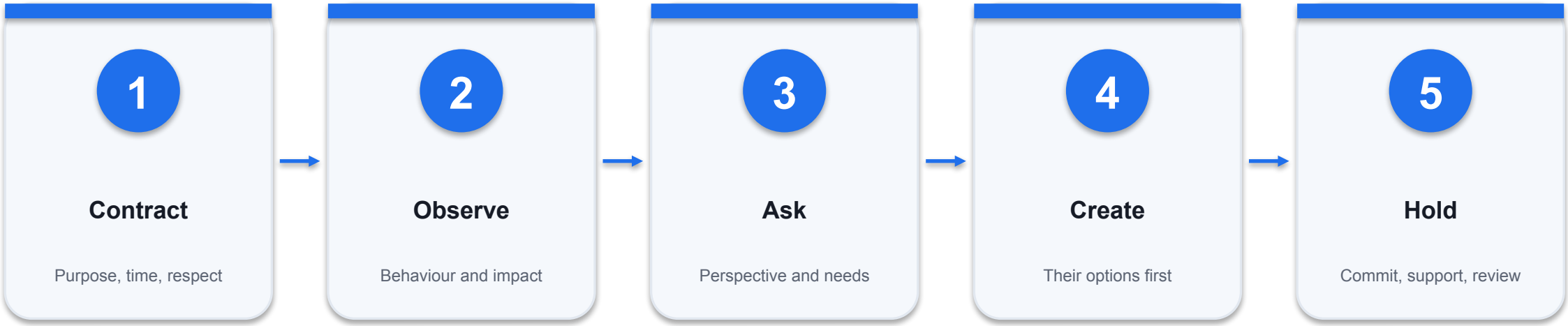
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Leader Behaviours that Build Psychological Safety

1. **Invite dissent**
   Ask for concerns before deciding: 'What are we missing?'
2. **Respond productively**
   Thank the challenger; never punish bad news.
3. **Separate debate from decision**
   Debate openly, then explain who decides and why.
4. **Clarify decision rights**
   Make roles, handoffs and authority explicit.
5. **Intervene early**
   Address personal attacks at once; protect voice.
6. **Close the loop**
   Report back what changed because someone spoke up.

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The COACH Conversation for Leaders

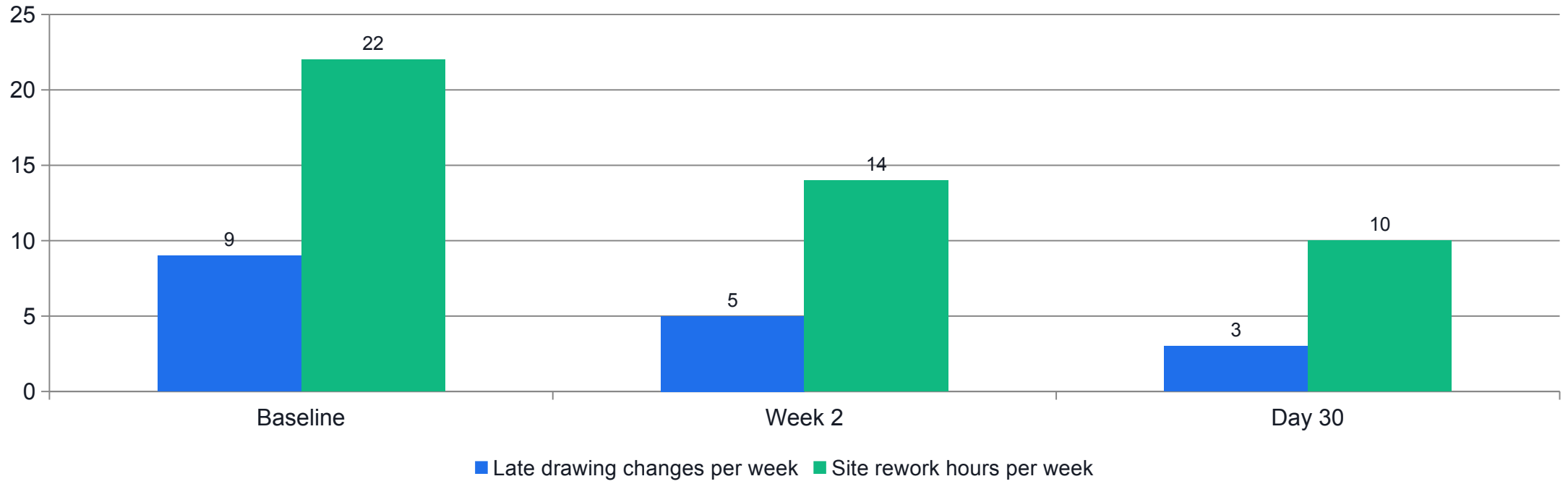


COACH THE PERSON, FIX THE SYSTEM

Accountability lasts when the leader also changes the conditions — decision rights, workload, norms — that kept producing the conflict.

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Monitoring Indicators — GreenGrid 30-Day Review



WHAT THE DATA SHOWS

Both lagging indicators improved, and the 'safe to raise concerns' pulse rose from 2.4 to 3.6 of 5. But the 3 remaining late changes were safety-related — the cut-off itself lacks a legitimate exception route.

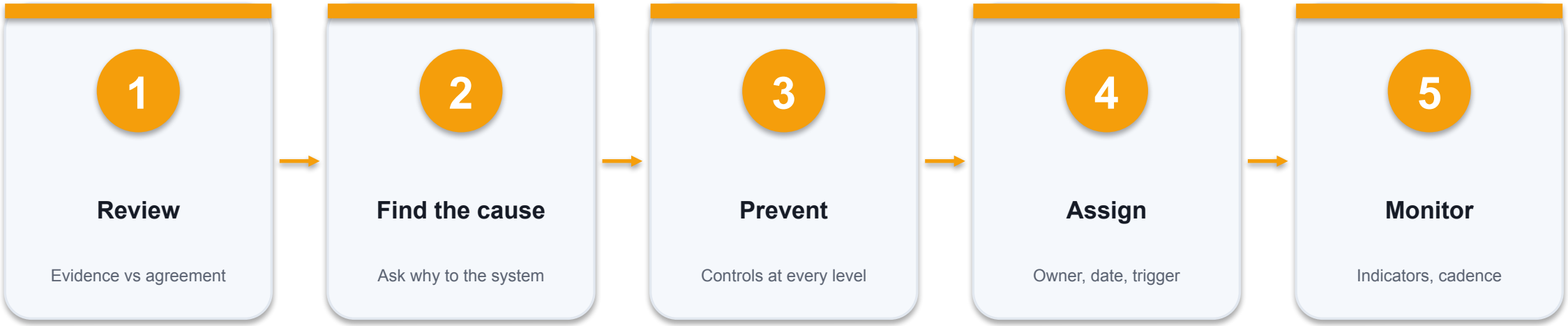
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Weak Follow-Up vs Effective Review

Weak follow-up	Effective review	Indicator type
Ask whether everyone is okay	Check named behaviours against the baseline	Behaviour
Assume silence means success	Use a confidential pulse and check-ins	People experience
Review only the two individuals	Review handoffs, decision rights, workload	Process
Close the file after an apology	Track rework, delays, complaints over time	Work results / risk

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Root-Cause Review and Preventive Action



AGREEMENT IS A HYPOTHESIS

Follow-up evidence tells you whether the resolution worked — and which guideline or protocol must change next.

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LO5 · TOPIC 05 · ACTIVITY 7

Leader Coaching Huddle at NovaTech Services

ACTIVITY 7 Role play · coaching triads · 25 minutes

THE SITUATION

At NovaTech Services, project lead Jordan feels that analyst Alex dismisses project decisions in meetings. Alex says Jordan closes discussion too quickly and uses seniority to override technical concerns. Two other analysts have stopped speaking up.

OBJECTIVE

Coach a team leader to build psychological safety and constructive dialogue, and turn the coaching into a team norm.

YOU'LL PRODUCE

A completed COACH planner, an observed coaching dialogue, and a team norm with two leader behaviours and a review date.

MATERIALS

COACH planner · psychological-safety behaviour card · observer sheet

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ACTIVITY 7 · ROLE CARDS

Scenario & Roles — NovaTech Services

Department manager Taylor will coach Jordan — not decide the dispute. Jordan must leave with leadership behaviours that invite dissent, clear decision rights and a team norm that keeps disagreement constructive.

T

Taylor · Department Manager (Coach)

GOAL

Build Jordan's capability.

BRIEF

Uses questions, reframing and rehearsal; keeps clear boundaries between coaching and formal action.

J

Jordan · Project Lead

GOAL

Restore respectful challenge and decision clarity.

BRIEF

Feels undermined but must examine own defensiveness and use of authority.

O

Observer · Feedback Partner

GOAL

Assess coaching quality.

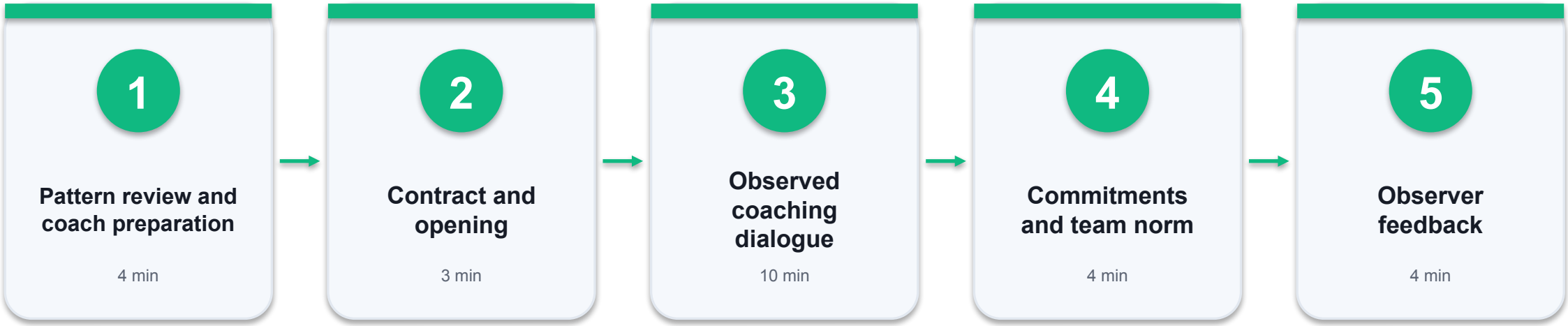
BRIEF

Checks neutrality, ownership, psychological-safety behaviours and follow-up.

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ACTIVITY 7 · PROCESS MAP

How Activity 7 Runs — 25 Minutes



THE POINT

Coach a team leader to build psychological safety and constructive dialogue, and turn the coaching into a team norm.

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ACTIVITY 7 · PROCEDURE

Activity 7 Procedure — Step by Step

1. **Review the pattern**
   Identify repeated team behaviours, their impact on work and what the leader may be reinforcing through action or silence.

2. **Prepare the coach**
   Write the purpose, two observable examples, open questions and the boundary between coaching and formal performance or grievance handling.

3. **Contract**
   Clarify purpose, time and the shared aim of restoring constructive challenge in the team.

4. **Observe and ask**
   Describe specific behaviour and impact without motive claims, then ask open questions about Jordan's perspective, needs and pressures.

5. **Explore leader behaviours**
   Use the behaviour card: invite dissent before deciding, thank challengers, separate debate from decision, explain decision rights, close the loop.

6. **Create options**
   Jordan proposes actions first; Taylor adds support, team norms and workflow changes.

7. **Hold commitment**
   Agree two observable leader behaviours, a team norm, support, evidence of progress and a review date.

8. **Observer feedback**
   The observer scores listening, neutrality, specificity, psychological safety and follow-up, then the triad drafts the team norm wording.

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ACTIVITY 7 · DEBRIEF & CHECK

Debrief — Leader Coaching Huddle at NovaTech Services

✅ **DEBRIEF STANDARD** The coaching keeps ownership with Jordan, commits to observable psychological-safety behaviours and a team norm, and sets a review date.

DISCUSS

- Which questions helped Jordan separate facts, feelings, assumptions and needs?
- Which leader behaviours most affect whether people speak up?
- How can Jordan invite challenge without reopening every decision?
- When should Taylor move from coaching to formal action?

IF THE GROUP GETS STUCK

Coach gives the answers

Ask before telling — 'What would you try?' builds ownership and capability.

Plan only fixes Alex

Add at least one change in leader behaviour or team system.

Behaviours are vague

Make them observable: 'ask for two concerns before every decision' rather than 'be more open'.

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30-Day Resolution Review at GreenGrid Engineering

ACTIVITY 8

Case study · review panel · 30 minutes

THE SITUATION

GreenGrid Engineering mediated a conflict between design lead Noor and site lead Ethan after repeated late drawing changes caused site rework. They agreed respectful language, a 3:00pm change cut-off and a weekly coordination meeting.

OBJECTIVE

Monitor resolution effectiveness with balanced indicators, run a root-cause review and design preventive controls and guideline updates.

YOU'LL PRODUCE

A 30-day review scorecard, a root-cause summary and a prevention plan with owners, triggers and a guideline update.

MATERIALS

Review scorecard · root-cause template · prevention-plan template

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ACTIVITY 8 · ROLE CARDS

Scenario & Roles — GreenGrid Engineering

Thirty days later, late changes fell from 9 to 3 a week, rework fell from 22 to 10 hours a week, and the 'I can raise concerns safely' pulse rose from 2.4 to 3.6 out of 5. But the three remaining late changes were safety-related, and one came from unclear approval authority. Learners judge effectiveness and design recurrence controls.

RL

Review Lead

GOAL

Evaluate fairly and improve the system.

BRIEF

Uses evidence, protects confidentiality and separates outcomes from blame.

N

Noor · Design Lead

GOAL

Protect design integrity.

BRIEF

Reports better dialogue but unclear authority for urgent safety changes.

E

Ethan · Site Lead

GOAL

Reduce rework and schedule risk.

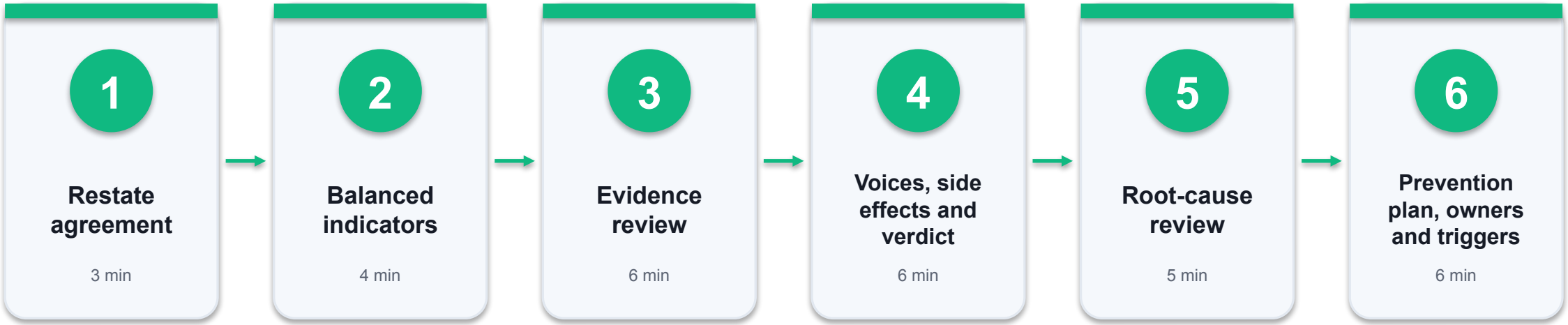
BRIEF

Sees improvement but wants a faster, legitimate exception route.

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ACTIVITY 8 · PROCESS MAP

How Activity 8 Runs — 30 Minutes



THE POINT

Monitor resolution effectiveness with balanced indicators, run a root-cause review and design preventive controls and guideline updates.

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ACTIVITY 8 · PROCEDURE

Activity 8 Procedure — Step by Step

1. **Restate the agreement**
   Summarise the agreement as observable commitments, owners, intended outcomes and review measures.
2. **Select balanced indicators**
   Use behaviour, process, work results, people experience and risk — never harmony or silence alone.
3. **Review the evidence**
   Compare baseline, week 2 and day 30 for each indicator; mark movement as positive, mixed or negative and note data confidence.
4. **Seek affected voices**
   Plan brief confidential check-ins on fairness, safety, workload and whether commitments occur in practice.
5. **Check unintended effects**
   Look for avoidance, hidden workarounds, unequal burden or the problem moving elsewhere.
6. **Decide effectiveness**
   Classify the resolution as effective, partially effective or ineffective, with an evidence-based rationale.
7. **Run the root-cause review**
   Ask 'why' until you reach a system cause — here, missing decision rights for urgent safety changes.
8. **Design prevention controls**
   Add controls at team, workflow, policy and leadership level — for example a safety-change exception route and an escalation-protocol update.
9. **Assign owners, triggers and review cadence**
   Give each control an owner, date, monitoring indicator and the trigger for escalation; schedule the next periodic review.

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ACTIVITY 8 · DEBRIEF & CHECK

Debrief — 30-Day Resolution Review at GreenGrid Engineering

✅ **DEBRIEF STANDARD** The review reaches an evidence-based verdict, identifies the system cause and adds preventive controls with owners, indicators, triggers and a review cadence.

DISCUSS

- Which parts of the resolution were effective, partly effective or ineffective?
- Should the three safety-related late changes count as breaches?
- Which recurrence cause is behavioural, and which is structural?
- What guideline or escalation-protocol change prevents the next conflict?

IF THE GROUP GETS STUCK

'It's solved — they get along'

Relationship repair is one indicator. Check the work, process and risk measures too.

All late changes treated as breaches

Separate safety-critical exceptions from non-compliance; design a legitimate exception route.

Controls have no owner

An unowned control does not exist — name a role, a date and the indicator that proves it works.

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TOPIC 05 · WHY IT MATTERS

Closure is an agreement; prevention is a changed system.

Guidelines, leader habits and periodic review turn one resolved conflict into a resilient organisation.

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Recap — Conflict-Resilient Organisation

1

Activity 7 · NovaTech Services

You can now: coach a team leader to build psychological safety and constructive dialogue, and turn the coaching into a team norm.

2

Activity 8 · GreenGrid Engineering

You can now: monitor resolution effectiveness with balanced indicators, run a root-cause review and design preventive controls and guideline updates.

3

LO5

Develop organisational guidelines and leadership strategies to prevent recurring conflicts and embed constructive conflict management practices.

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WRAP-UP

Course Summary & Next Steps

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LEARNING OUTCOMES

What You Achieved

1

LO1 · Analyse and select

Analyse conflict types, escalation stages and the five management styles to choose a fitting approach.

2

LO2 · De-escalate

Use active listening, empathy, reframing and non-verbal skills to calm and steer conflict conversations.

3

LO3 · Negotiate and build consensus

Negotiate on interests, manage resistance and power, and test consensus on a shared agreement.

4

LO4 · Resolve and mediate

Run a structured resolution or mediation and turn it into an actionable, policy-aligned plan.

5

LO5 · Prevent recurrence

Set guidelines, escalation protocols and leadership habits that keep conflict constructive.

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EVIDENCE BASE · VERIFY CURRENT POLICY BEFORE A REAL CASE

Sources & Further Reading

Harvard Program on Negotiation — conflict resolution strategies
pon.harvard.edu

UC Berkeley Ombuds — tips, tools and techniques
studentaffairs.berkeley.edu

Harvard Business School Online — workplace conflict resolution
online.hbs.edu

Singapore MOM — workplace grievances
mom.gov.sg

HelpGuide — conflict resolution skills
helpguide.org

Singapore MOM — Tripartite Advisory on Managing Workplace Harassment
mom.gov.sg

Coursera — conflict management styles and strategies
coursera.org

Singapore PDPC — personal data protection obligations
pdpc.gov.sg

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WRAP-UP · 5:00PM

Assessment

1

Written Assessment (WA)

30 minutes · open book · short-answer questions on LO1 and LO5.

2

Live Role Play (RP)

30 minutes · individual role play observed by the assessor on LO2, LO3 and LO4.

3

Digital attendance

Take the Assessment digital attendance and complete TRAQOM before you start.

4

Submit on the LMS

Upload your WA answers at lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com.

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ON ASSESSMENT DAY

Assessment Flow



REMEMBER

TRAQOM, the assessment digital attendance and the signed Assessment Summary Record are all required — the Role Play is observed live by the assessor, the WA is submitted on the LMS.

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Digital Attendance (Mandatory)

1

Three times a day

Take the AM, PM and Assessment digital attendance — mandatory for SkillsFuture-funded courses.

2

Trainer shows the QR

The trainer or administrator displays the digital attendance QR code from the SSG portal.

3

Scan and submit

Scan the QR code with your mobile phone camera and submit your attendance.

4

75% minimum

A minimum of 75% attendance is required to be eligible for assessment and funding.

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SEE YOU AT THE NEXT ONE

Thank You!

You can now recognise conflict early, de-escalate, negotiate, mediate and build a team that disagrees well.

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